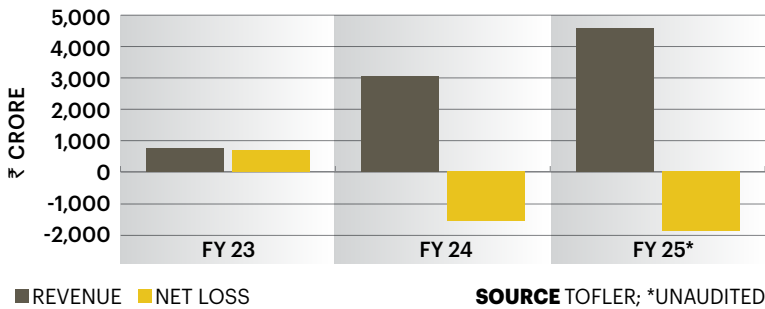
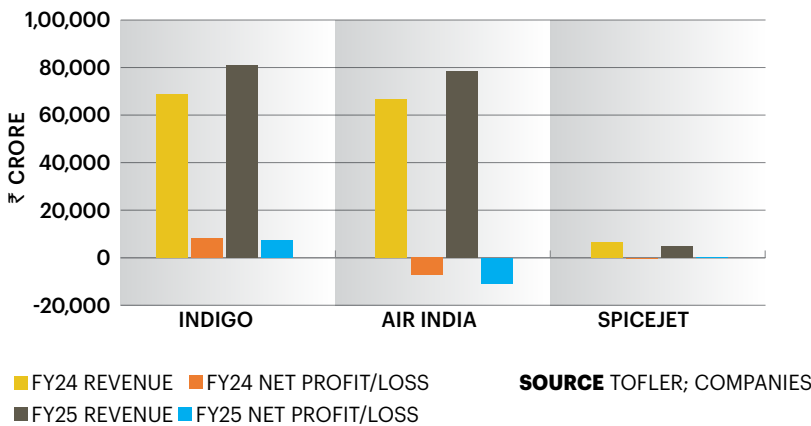


REVENUE SURGE

- Topline grew 49% in FY24; net loss widened by 18.7% on rising cost
- The revenue per available seat kilometre rose 13% YoY



THE COMPETITION



“Our model is about disciplined, sustainable growth. We’re not chasing market share for its own sake—we’re building an airline that can last, with the right partners, the right fleet, and the right culture”

VINAY DUBE
CEO, AKASA AIR



“Unit costs are trending down, ancillary and cargo streams are strong, and our growth capex is fully funded. The next phase is about scaling up profitably”

ANKUR GOEL
CFO, AKASA AIR

HEADWINDS APLENTY

Even though the airline has managed to attract more investment, in an industry where the two other carriers have nearly 90% market share, it is never going to be an easy ride for the rest.

The airline’s record order has, ironically, led to internal strife among employees, according to several reports. Critics note that Akasa has approximately 750 pilots, of whom over 300 are not actively flying due to delays in aircraft delivery. This has resulted in a situation where the grounded pilots are not receiving the same salary as those who are flying.

M. G. Mohan Kumar, former Chief Financial Officer and Finance Director of Air Deccan, feels the airline should never have placed orders for Boeing aircraft. “The aircraft it operates, particularly the Boeing models, are plagued with issues, leaving the airline severely impacted,” he says. He adds Akasa has hired far too many pilots when many of its aircraft haven’t been inducted, which is adding to the burden.

But Dubey counters the criticism: “Hiring was planned with an 18–24-month horizon, factoring in notice periods and Boeing 737 training needs. As deliveries resume, these pilots will progressively move into active duty. We don’t hire for today, we hire for tomorrow.”

That isn’t the only issue regarding its pilots. Insiders report that there have been instances of pilots leaving before their contractual notice period. This has forced the airline to request compensation for the lost notice period.

The management is clear that the steps taken were appropriate. When a certain number of pilots quit without fulfilling their notice period, the result was flight cancellations and disruptions. About 600 flights were cancelled in August 2023 when 43 pilots quit suddenly, according to various reports.